



◀ ASUS ZENFONE 5 (8 GB)

Price: ₹9,999

Smartphones Under 10k

The competition in the smartphone market has long moved to the mid-range and budget department. It is in this range where the sales happen the most and the compromise has been reduced, thanks to Motorola and some others. A lot happened in this range this year, with companies like Xiaomi entering with their new business models. Online sales are allowing them to cut the prices, while selling devices which were once considered to not belong to the under 10k segment.

There's a lot of competition here and it is quite close. The contenders, Asus, Motorola, Xiaomi, Huawei and many others, have all made legitimate claims on the consumer's pocket. This one is probably the toughest range to choose from.

Zero 1 Winner Asus Zenfone 5 (8 GB)

Asus made a major statement with its Zenfone series of smartphones. The best amongst the Zenfones is the Zenfone 5, which sports an Intel Z2560 dual-core

SoC with hyperthreading technology. The phone performs like a boss, with Asus's ZenUI running smooth and lag free.

The hyperthreading technology essentially allows the dual core processor in the Zenfone act like a quad-core, giving it high benchmark scores on AnTuTu, 3D Mark etc. On top of that, the Zenfone 5 offers an 8MP camera that is better than some 13 MP shooters in the market. To top it all off, the phone's battery lasts you a full day very easily. There really was no room for complaints.

Second Place

Moto E

You just can't ignore this phone can you? The Moto E was for long the best phone in this department. In fact, if not for the Zenfone 5, it would perhaps have taken the prize yet again. The phone landed in second place because the Zenfone 5 essentially offers the same performance as the first gen Moto G, the Moto E's elder brother.

The Moto E is still a good phone to buy, but it doesn't have a good camera and isn't the performer that the Zenfone 5 is. The phone was meant to revolutionise the budget range and it did that, but the competition is tougher now and its older hardware and weaker performance means Motorola will have to upgrade in order to get back in the driver's seat.



Moto E

Price: ₹6,999

Third Place

Xiaomi Redmi 1S, Android One

We couldn't complete this list without mentioning a few more phones. The Xiaomi Redmi 1S would take the cake, if these awards were for the most disruptive smartphone in the market. The online strategy, combined with the first gen Moto G-like specifications made it the most interesting smartphone in ages. The phone didn't live up to the spec-sheet though and that disappointed us and dropped it to the third place. It's still a value for money device.

Google also made an effort to revolutionise the budget range, but the Android One phones seem to have fizzled out. We're yet to see the 'revolution' as the phones seem to offer nothing out of the ordinary and can't make a legitimate claim over the others in this segment.

The benchmark scores for these devices are mediocre, even lower than the Moto E, meaning they're nowhere close to what the Zenfone 5 offers. Perhaps future Android One phones will make a difference, but for now, the first three phones by Micromax, Karbonn and Spice don't hold a candle to the others mentioned on this list. 



Xiaomi Redmi 1S

Price: ₹5,999



Android One

Price: ₹6k to ₹7k